

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Port-In Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

Document ID	AW-SRV-001
Version	2.5
Last Updated	August 2026
Department	Carrier Services
Company	Aether Wireless
Classification	Internal — Training & Reference

Overview

This document establishes the policies and procedures for number porting into Aether Wireless from other carriers. It covers eligibility requirements, required customer information, expected porting timelines, common failure scenarios, troubleshooting procedures, and resolution protocols. All retail staff and customer care representatives must follow these guidelines when assisting customers requesting to port their existing phone numbers to Aether Wireless.

Port-in requests are processed through the Carrier Services Port Desk. Representatives must verify all eligibility criteria before initiating a port request. Numbers can only be ported from US-based carriers; international number porting is not supported. All port requests must comply with FCC regulations governing local number portability (LNP).

Section 1: Eligibility Requirements

A phone number is eligible for porting to Aether Wireless only when all of the following conditions are met:

- **Active Number Status:** The number must be currently active on the donor carrier's network. Disconnected, vanity, or reserved numbers are not eligible.
- **Good Standing Account:** The account on the losing carrier must be in good standing with no outstanding balances, disputes, or collection actions.
- **TPIN Verification:** The customer must provide a valid Transfer PIN (TPIN) from the losing carrier. This PIN is carrier-specific and required for authentication.
- **Account Number:** The customer must provide the exact account number from the losing carrier as it appears on their bill.
- **Not Mid-Port:** The number must not currently be in the process of being ported to another carrier.
- **Not Suspended:** The line must not be suspended, terminated, or on hold with the losing carrier.
- **No Pending Device Obligations:** The customer must have fulfilled all device payment obligations, including installment plans, lease agreements, or equipment subsidies associated with the number.

Ineligible Scenarios

The following scenarios make a number ineligible for porting:

- Numbers currently suspended by the losing carrier for non-payment
- Numbers with an active device payment plan balance due
- Numbers already submitted for porting to another carrier (mid-port status)
- Corporate or business numbers requiring additional authorization
- Prepaid numbers attempting to port to postpaid (separate rules apply)
- Numbers on accounts with fraud flags or security holds

Section 2: Required Information

The following information must be collected and verified before submitting any port-in request. Incomplete or incorrect information will result in port delays or rejection.

Data Field	Requirement	Notes
Phone Number to Port	10-digit US number	Must be active and in service
Losing Carrier Name	Exact carrier name	Must match carrier records
Account Number	Full account number	Must match losing carrier billing exactly
Transfer PIN (TPIN)	4-6 digit PIN	Provided by losing carrier
Account Holder Name	Full legal name	Must match losing carrier account
Billing Address	Complete street address	Must match losing carrier records
Service Address	Complete street address	May differ from billing address
Account Holder ID	Government-issued ID	Required for verification

Name and Address Matching

The customer's name and billing address on the Aether Wireless account must exactly match the information on file with the losing carrier. Minor discrepancies—such as abbreviations (St. vs Street), unit numbers (Apt 3 vs #3), or spelling variations—may cause port rejection. Representatives must carefully verify each field character-by-character before submission.

Section 3: Porting Timelines

Porting timelines vary based on the type of port, carrier involved, and geographic region. The following estimates represent standard processing times from the time of successful submission.

Port Type	Processing Time	Business Days
Same Region (same area code, same carrier group)	2-4 hours	Same business day
Cross-Region (different area code, same carrier)	24-48 hours	1-2 business days
Cross-Carrier (different carrier)	24-48 hours	1-2 business days
Corporate / Business Account	3-5 business days	3-5 business days
Prepaid to Postpaid	24-48 hours	1-2 business days

Important Notes

- Timelines begin when all required information is validated and the port request is successfully submitted to the losing carrier.
- Delays may occur if the losing carrier does not respond to validation requests within their required timeframe.
- Ports submitted after 5:00 PM ET or on weekends/holidays are processed on the next business day.
- Aether Wireless only supports porting of US phone numbers. International number porting is not available.
- Port-in requests cannot be expedited but may be prioritized if there is a confirmed service disruption or urgent business need.

Section 4: Common Failure Reasons and Resolutions

The following table identifies the most frequent reasons for port failures and the corresponding resolution steps.

Failure Reason	Cause	Resolution
Invalid TPIN	Customer provided wrong or expired PIN	Contact losing carrier to obtain current PIN; request customer to call donor carrier directly
Incorrect Account Number	Number does not match carrier records	Verify account number on customer bill; confirm against carrier account lookup
Name/Address Mismatch	Information does not exactly match donor records	Request updated account info from losing carrier; update customer records to match
Suspended Line	Line is suspended with losing carrier	Customer must resolve suspension with donor carrier before port can proceed
Pending Device Balance	Equipment installment balance owed	Customer must pay remaining device balance; obtain payoff confirmation
Already Mid-Port	Number currently porting to another carrier	Wait for current port to complete; verify with losing carrier
Losing Carrier Blocking	Donor carrier rejecting port request	Escalate to Port Desk; Carrier Relations may need to contact donor carrier
Number Not Active	Number disconnected or not in service	Customer must reactivate with losing carrier before porting

Section 5: Port Process Step-by-Step

Representatives must follow these exact steps when processing a port-in request:

Step 1: Verify Eligibility

1. Confirm the number is active on the losing carrier's network.
2. Verify the account is in good standing with no outstanding balances.
3. Confirm the line is not suspended or pending disconnection.
4. Verify no pending device payment obligations exist.

Step 2: Collect Information

1. Obtain all required fields from the information table (Section 2).
2. Verify the account holder's identity with government-issued photo ID.
3. Confirm the name and billing address match the losing carrier exactly.

Step 3: Obtain TPIN

1. Instruct the customer to obtain a TPIN from the losing carrier.
2. Provide the customer with the losing carrier's customer service number if needed.
3. Note: Some carriers allow TPIN retrieval online or via their mobile app.

Step 4: Submit Port Request

1. Log into the Port Desk system.
2. Enter all collected information exactly as provided.
3. Submit the port request and record the confirmation number.
4. Provide the customer with the port request confirmation number.

Step 5: Monitor and Confirm

1. Track the port status in the Carrier Services portal.
2. Notify the customer of any issues or delays within 4 hours.
3. Confirm successful port completion with the customer.

Section 6: Zero-Day Trouble Resolution

If a port-in fails or experiences issues on the scheduled port date, representatives must escalate immediately to the Port Desk for resolution.

Escalation Process

1. **Create a Case Number:** Generate a unique case number in the Port Desk ticketing system.
2. **Initial Investigation:** The Port Desk team will investigate within 24 hours, contacting the losing carrier to identify the failure reason.
3. **Customer Callback:** A Port Desk representative will call the customer within 4 hours of case creation to provide an update.
4. **Escalation to Carrier Relations:** If the issue cannot be resolved within 24 hours, the case escalates to the Carrier Relations team, which contacts the donor carrier's porting department directly.

Resolution Commitments

- Port Desk operates Monday through Friday, 8:00 AM - 8:00 PM ET
- Urgent cases (no service) receive priority handling
- Complex rejections may require 48-72 hours for full resolution
- All escalation cases receive a final resolution or status update within 3 business days

Section 7: Partial Porting

Customers may request to port only specific lines from a multi-line account. This is known as a partial port.

Partial Port Rules

- Each line ported requires its own separate port request.
- The customer must provide account information for each line being ported.
- Remaining lines on the account will continue service with the original carrier.
- Partial port requests take the same timeframe as standard port requests per line.
- All eligibility requirements apply to each individual line.

Section 8: Service Interruption Notice

Customers should be advised that a brief service interruption may occur during the port transfer. This interruption typically lasts 15 minutes to 2 hours, occurring during the final activation of the number on the Aether Wireless network.

Aether Wireless recommends:

- Scheduling port-ins during off-peak hours when possible
- Informing the customer of potential interruption before finalizing the request
- Providing an estimated completion window based on port type

In the event of extended interruption exceeding 4 hours, representatives must create a priority ticket with the Port Desk and notify the customer of resolution steps.

FAQs

Q: Can I port a number from any US carrier to Aether Wireless?

A: Yes, Aether Wireless accepts port-in requests from all major US carriers including AT&T, Verizon, T-Mobile, US Cellular, and most regional carriers. The number must be active, in good standing, and not have pending device obligations.

Q: What is a TPIN and how do I get one?

A: A TPIN (Transfer PIN) is a security code required by your current carrier to authorize the port. You can obtain it by logging into your current carrier's online account or mobile app, or by calling your carrier's customer service. Some carriers provide it immediately, while others may take 24-48 hours to release it.

Q: How long does a port-in take?

A: Most port-ins complete within 2-4 hours if within the same region and carrier group. Cross-region and cross-carrier ports typically take 24-48 hours. Business accounts may require 3-5 business days. These timelines are estimates and may vary based on the losing carrier's response time.

Q: What happens if my port fails?

A: If your port fails, the Port Desk team will contact you within 4 hours to identify the issue. Common reasons include incorrect account information, invalid TPIN, or pending balances with your current carrier. Once the issue is resolved, we will resubmit the port request at no additional cost.

Q: Will I have any service interruption during the port?

A: You may experience a brief interruption of 15 minutes to 2 hours during the transfer. We recommend scheduling port-ins during times when you can be without service briefly. Your number will remain active with your current carrier until the transfer is complete.

Q: Can I port a prepaid number to Aether Wireless postpaid service?

A: Yes, prepaid-to-postpaid porting is supported with a processing time of 24-48 hours. The number must be active, and you must provide the account information from the prepaid carrier. Note that some prepaid carriers may have specific requirements for releasing numbers.

For additional assistance with port-in requests, contact the Port Desk at 1-800-555-0147 or via the internal Carrier Services chat portal. Available Monday-Friday, 8:00 AM - 8:00 PM ET.